“I’m an actor, not a politician,” I said several times. “I’m in show business.”

But they claimed the party was in such shambles following the 1964 election that its survival as a force in California was in doubt and, mentioning my speech for Goldwater, they said they thought I might be the only Republican around who had a chance of beating Brown and bringing the party back together.

Nothing was said, incidentally, about whether I would make a good governor or not. They just said I was the only one who could bring the party together.

I told them that running for governor was out of the question for me, but that I wanted to help the party and made a proposition: Find somebody you think would make a good governor and then I’ll campaign for him as hard as I can, the way I campaigned for Barry. “Pick your candidate and I guarantee you I’ll campaign for him, whoever it is,” I said.

When they left, I hoped I’d put the idea to rest. But they kept coming back, and then the Federated Republican Women’s Club sent a delegation to the house urging me to run and I told them I wasn’t interested in political office, I was happy in show business.

Nancy had no more interest in my running for governor than I did and she was just as flabbergasted by the idea as I was. We loved our life as it was and didn’t want it to change.

We had our children, our friends in Hollywood, our home, our ranch, our privacy; we had a good income and all the opportunities I ever wanted to speak about the issues that concerned me.

I was approaching an age when some of the men I knew were already starting to think about retirement. Although I didn’t have any thought of retirement, I had a good job and a good life and, at fifty-four, the last thing I wanted to do was start a new career.